



INTERNATIONAL FOUNDATION FOR DIGITAL CHILD

Conflict of Interest Policy (CIP)

2023



IFDC 

1. Purpose

This policy outlines guidelines and procedures for identifying, disclosing, and managing conflicts of interest within IFDC, encompassing staff, board members, and associates. It serves to uphold IFDC's decision-making integrity and protect the organization's interests.

2. Objective

The objective of this policy is to ensure that all IFDC staff, board members, and associates are aware of their obligation to disclose conflicts of interest and are committed to managing such conflicts effectively, thereby safeguarding IFDC's reputation and mission.

3. Definition of Conflicts of Interest

At IFDC, a conflict of interest arises when an individual's personal interests or affiliations could compromise their ability to act in the best interests of IFDC and its mission. These conflicts occur when personal interests clash with organizational responsibilities, potentially undermining IFDC's credibility, transparency, and effectiveness, while also raising ethical and legal concerns.

4. Common Scenarios Creating Conflicts of Interest

IFDC recognizes common conflict scenarios, including:

- a. **Financial Interests:** When individuals associated with IFDC have financial interests in companies, organizations, or projects interacting with IFDC.
- b. **Family Relationships:** Conflicts may arise when family members of IFDC staff or board members are involved in activities or organizations collaborating with IFDC.
- c. **Political or Personal Affiliations:** When individuals within IFDC hold strong political or personal affiliations that conflict with IFDC's mission or values.
- d. **Dual Roles:** Individuals holding dual roles, such as being an IFDC board member and serving on another organization's board interacting with IFDC.
- e. **Gifts and Perks:** Acceptance of gifts, privileges, or favors from organizations or individuals collaborating with IFDC.

5. Identification and Disclosure

- a. All IFDC associates are required to proactively identify and disclose actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest.
- b. The Register of Interests will document the nature and extent of conflicts and actions taken to address them.
- c. Disclosures will be treated with confidentiality and restricted access.

6. Management of Conflicts of Interest

Upon disclosure, the Executive Director and the board (excluding the conflicted member) will determine how to manage conflicts, taking into account factors such as severity, impact, available alternatives, alignment with IFDC's mission, and available resources. Decisions will be documented in meeting minutes and the Register of Interests.

7. Review

This Conflict-of-Interest Policy will be subject to an annual review by the board to ensure its continued effectiveness and relevance. For questions or clarifications, please contact the board via president@ifdchild.org.

8. Compliance Section for IFDC's Conflict of Interest Policy

To maintain IFDC's integrity and ethical standards, all associates must adhere to these compliance measures:

- a. **Reprimand or Warning:** Minor conflicts or first-time offenses may result in a formal reprimand or warning, with mandatory acknowledgment.
- b. **Removal from Decision-Making:** Individuals with conflicts must promptly recuse themselves to ensure impartial decisions. Failure to comply may lead to further action.
- c. **Recovery of Gains:** If an individual benefits financially, IFDC may require prompt reimbursement.
- d. **Suspension or Termination:** In cases of severe or repeated conflicts, IFDC may suspend or terminate involvement, following internal policies.
- e. **Legal Action:** In cases involving illegal activities, IFDC may pursue legal action, requiring cooperation.
- f. **Loss of Board Position:** Board members may be asked to resign to preserve governance integrity.
- g. **Fines and Penalties:** Compliance with legal requirements is mandatory.
- h. **Public Disclosure:** IFDC may publicly disclose conflicts and actions taken as part of transparency and accountability efforts.

9. Reporting Channels

IFDC associates can report conflicts of interest through the following channels:

- a. **Staff - HR Manager (HR@ifdchild.org):** All staff members are encouraged to promptly report conflicts of interest to our HR Manager. This channel is ideal for addressing conflicts related to staff members' roles and responsibilities within the organization.
- b. **Senior Management/Heads/Directors - CEO (CEO@ifdchild.org):** Senior management, department heads, and directors should report conflicts of interest directly to the CEO. This channel ensures that conflicts at higher levels of responsibility are appropriately managed.
- c. **Board Members - President (President@ifdchild.org):** Board members, who play a crucial role in guiding IFDC's mission, should report any conflicts of interest to the President. This channel allows for the impartial handling of conflicts involving our governing body.

11. Confidentiality and Protection

Rest assured that all disclosures will be handled confidentially with restricted access to protect your privacy and the integrity of the process. IFDC is committed to safeguarding those who report conflicts of interest from any form of retaliation. All IFDC associates must adhere to these compliance measures to uphold the organization's integrity and ethical standards.

Appendix I – Annual Conflict of Interest Declaration Form

Annual Conflict of Interest Declaration Form

This form should be completed before February 1 each year by all board members, senior leadership team members, and staff members in finance (accounting), procurement, and HR roles.

Your name:

Your position:

I understand that a conflict of interest arises if an employee or a board member has an interest, relationship, or friendship that could, or could be seen to, interfere with their ability to decide an issue in the best interests of IFDC.

I understand that the existence of a conflict of interest does not constitute a breach of policy, so long as it is declared, so that it may be properly managed.

I have been shown a list of current board members, staff members, suppliers and partners, which is attached to this declaration.

I hereby declare that I have no known personal or business relationships or interests with any other staff member, board member, current supplier, or contractor, except for:

Name	Nature of relationship
1.	
2.	
3.	

I further state that I will declare any conflict of interest arising during the year as soon as I become aware of it.

Name:

Sign:

Date:

The signed form should be filed on a conflict's declaration file, with a copy on the personal file. The individual may retain a copy of the lists if they wish.

Appendix II – Recruitment Conflict of Interest Declaration Form

Recruitment conflict of interest declaration form

This form should be completed by anyone involved with access to the relevant recruitment selection tools or involved in the selection process.

Position being recruited:

Your name:

Your role in the selection process:

I hereby declare that I have been shown a complete list of the applicants for the above position and that I do not personally know any of them except for:

Name	Nature of relationship
1.	
2.	
3.	

I further declare that I have not and will not provide any assistance, favour, or guidance to any applicant during the selection process.

Name:

Sign:

Date:

The signed form should be filed on the recruitment file, with a copy on the above-named staff member's personal file.

Appendix III – Declaration of Conflict-of-Interest Form

Conflict of Interest Declaration Form

This form should be completed by any staff or board member who becomes aware of a conflict of interest arising during the year. It should be filed as soon as the individual becomes aware of the conflict.

Name:	
Position:	

I understand that a conflict of interest arises if an employee or a board member has an interest, relationship, or friendship that could, or could be seen to, interfere with their ability to decide an issue in the best interests of IFDC. I understand that the existence of a conflict of interest does not constitute a breach of policy, so long as it is declared, so that it may be properly managed.

I hereby declare the following conflict of interest:

Name of person or organization	
Nature of conflict	
Date conflict arose	

Sign:

Date:

To be completed by Leadership Team member:

Actions taken to mitigate risk of above declared conflict:

Name:

Sign:

Date:

The signed form should be filed on a conflict's declaration file, with a copy on the personal file